

# John Escobedo

Senior QA & UAT Lead | Accessibility (508/WCAG) & AI Output Validation | User-Centered, Trilingual Quality

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Austin, Texas

**Summary:** Senior QA and UAT lead with 18+ years making software work, and making it work for everyone. I build and lead quality and user-acceptance testing from the ground up, combining technical rigor (test strategy, API and platform testing, JIRA and TestRail, requirements-to-coverage traceability) with deep accessibility expertise (Section 508 and WCAG, hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation) and AI-validation skills (LLM output validation, red-teaming, and hallucination detection). Equally central is the human side of quality: I advocate for the end user, communicate clearly with technical and business stakeholders, stay calm and supportive with people under pressure, and bring a trilingual perspective (English, Spanish, and ASL) shaped by years working alongside the Deaf and accessibility community. I test not only whether software functions, but whether it genuinely serves the people who depend on it.

## SKILLS

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### Test Strategies

UAT, Regression, Agile, Functional, Integration, Smoke, Sanity, Exploratory, Black Box, System, Usability, End-to-end, API, Acceptance, 508 Compliance, HIPAA Compliance, Cross-browser, Cross-platform, Mobile, Desktop, Web Application, Release Validation, Data Integrity, Compatibility, Verification, Validation Testing

### Manual Testing & QA Process

Manual Testing, Test Planning, Test Case Design, Bug Reporting, Test Strategy Writing, QA Process Implementation

### API Testing

SOAP API Testing, REST API Testing, Postman, Chrome Developer Tools

### Platform Testing

.NET Platform Testing, Java Platform Testing, Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (PC/Mac/Linux), Cross-browser/Cross-platform

### Business Analysis

Requirements Elicitation, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Process Mapping & Documentation, Gap Analysis, Stakeholder Management, Change Management

### Problem-Solving & Analysis

Attention to Detail, Analytical Thinking, Problem-Solving, Critical Thinking, Root Cause Analysis, Troubleshooting

### Leadership & Process

QA Process Implementation, Team Leadership, Process Standardization, SDLC, Agile/Scrum, Production Support

### Testing Methodologies & Frameworks

Agile Testing, Regression Testing, User Acceptance Testing (UAT), Test Planning, CI/CD Testing, Accessibility & 508 Testing

### AI & Prompt Engineering

Prompt Engineering & Optimization, AI Red Teaming & Adversarial Testing, LLM Output Validation & QA, Hallucination Detection & Fact-Checking, LLM Prompt Pipeline Design, AI Workflow Automation

### Test Management & Documentation

JIRA/Xray, JIRA Administration, Confluence, TestRail, SOP Development, Risk Management

### Training & Enablement

Curriculum Development, Adult Learning Facilitation, Software Instruction, Onboarding & Knowledge Transfer, Documentation & SOP Creation, One-on-One Coaching

### Interpersonal & Collaboration

Clear Communication, Curiosity, Cross-functional Collaboration, Mentoring, Agile Coaching, Public Speaking & MC

### Customer Service & Support

High-Touch Customer Support, De-escalation & Conflict Resolution, Account Recovery & Restoration, Live Chat Support, Ticket System Support (Parature), Empathetic Communication

## **Accessibility & Inclusive Design**

508 Compliance Testing, WCAG Awareness, JAWS Screen Reader, NVDA Screen Reader, Inclusive Product Advocacy, American Sign Language (Conversational)

## **Platforms & Environments**

Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (PC, Mac, Linux), Cross-browser/Cross-platform, REST API Testing, Gaming Platforms & Consoles

## **Tools & Technologies**

GitHub, Chrome Developer Tools, SQL / JQL, JavaScript/HTML/CSS, Command Line Interfaces, Postman

## **Industry Expertise**

Healthcare & Telehealth, Gaming & Entertainment, Educational Technology, Live Events & Hosting, Government & Veterans Affairs, Virtual Reality (VR)

## **Office and Image Suites**

Adobe Creative Suite, Office 365: Teams, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Google Workspace: Drive, Docs, Sheets, Canva, JIRA Confluence, GIMP

## **A/V Production & Coordination**

Live Sound Engineering & Mixing, A/V Equipment Operation & Troubleshooting, Client & Performer Coordination, Music Programming & Live Cueing, Event Atmosphere Management, Technical Setup & Strike Efficiency

# **PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE**

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## **Software Tester (Volunteer)**

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performed exploratory testing on a new web application, found silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, and contributed fixes and documentation directly to the codebase.

- Ran end-to-end exploratory testing across browsers and platforms, validating full user workflows.
  - Caught silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, including cases where the app returned blank responses with no error signal.
  - Built a custom failure-report template so any reader, technical or not, could immediately see what broke.
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## **Karaoke Host**

Freelance | Austin, TX

July 2025 to Present

Hosted live karaoke events, running sound and software while managing the room and adapting the flow to the crowd.

- Ran event flow and timing, adjusting live to audience requests and room energy.
  - Juggled the song queue, timing, and room energy to keep the night moving.
  - Handled sound systems, karaoke software, and on-the-fly troubleshooting so events ran without interruption.
  - Kept the atmosphere welcoming so first-timers felt comfortable stepping up alongside regulars.
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## **Robot Tele-Operator**

Apptronik (via Insight Global) | Austin, TX

July 2025 to September 2025

Tested and documented humanoid robot behavior for Apptronik, writing procedures and bug reports engineering could act on directly.

- Cut physical test setup time by 75% by standardizing the preparation pattern, giving data collection consistent, repeatable conditions.
- Turned observed robot behaviors into clear bug reports engineering could act on immediately.
- Wrote startup, shutdown, and emergency shutdown procedures for 2 robot models where none existed, cutting new-tester ramp-up time by roughly 50% and becoming the team standard.

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## Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL  
March 2019 to June 2025

Led QA, UAT, and requirements analysis across multiple VA healthcare projects, drove Agile process adoption, and served as SME for complex clinical modules.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions so cross-functional teams could navigate the clinical requirements.
- Drove the Waterfall-to-Agile transition, introducing code freeze and release-candidate practices that shifted teams from reactive firefighting to predictable delivery.
- Managed test cases, defects, requirements documentation, and project dashboards in JIRA and Confluence across 6+ years and multiple VA projects.
- Ran SOAP API testing on VA home loan .NET applications and REST API testing via Postman on Java healthcare modules, validating service queries, data contracts, and data integrity.
- Built and executed test strategies for VA clinical healthcare applications across .NET and Java, covering UAT, regression, integration, smoke, sanity, end-to-end, and 508 compliance.
- Led 508 compliance initiatives and performed hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation on VA clinical interfaces, catching accessibility issues visual inspection misses.
- Partnered with automation engineers to validate Cucumber and Selenium scripts, catching requirement-to-execution gaps before tests went into rotation.
- Built requirements traceability documentation mapping every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile.

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## DJ

Freelance | Austin, TX  
January 2011 to April 2012

DJed dance events across Austin, working with venues and matching music to each event's tone and crowd.

- Built setlists for Danceversity, Dance International, and Synergy Dance Studio based on event style and audience preferences.
- Adapted to different in-house sound systems and venue quirks on the fly.
- Coordinated with event organizers to match music to the tone and timing of each event.

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## Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX  
June 2018 to October 2018

Established QA processes and JIRA workflows from the ground up for a health tech startup's secure patient portal, partnering with engineering and product leadership on release validation.

- As JIRA administrator, designed a unified workflow with custom issue types, permission schemes, notifications, and dashboards, giving engineering and product real-time visibility into release status.
- Defined the initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, bringing predictability to a fast-moving startup.
- Assessed release risk and delivered go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed to market with quality.
- Validated releases across major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production.

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## QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX  
July 2017 to June 2018

As sole QA, built quality processes and test infrastructure from zero for the flagship education assessment platform, earning trust with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices, including version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation, to a team shipping without formal QA process, integrating quality as a respected part of the SDLC.
- Created end-to-end test and product documentation covering procedures, requirements traceability, verification standards, and feature release notes.
- Standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity between developers and QA and speeding up delivery.
- Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.

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## **QA Tester | QA Analyst**

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX

May 2015 to May 2017

QA Analyst contracted to RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team testing for high-visibility e-commerce launches and aligning test priorities with business needs.

- Coordinated QA across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning test priorities with leadership expectations.
- Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity across the product.
- Triaged live production issues under pressure, communicating status updates to leadership during outages.
- Partnered with developers to improve internal tooling and CI/CD workflow, contributing changes that increased team efficiency.

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## **QA Test Lead | QA Analyst**

Communication Services for the Deaf | Austin, TX

May 2013 to January 2015

Built the QA function for a video interpreting platform serving Deaf and hard-of-hearing users, immersing in the community to shape testing around real user needs.

- Learned American Sign Language and Deaf cultural norms to understand user needs firsthand, using that immersion as a user research approach that shaped requirements validation.
- Established the company's first-ever QA function, defining test procedures and quality benchmarks that caught non-functional code blocking release.
- Owned validation across web and mobile, from test planning through stakeholder reporting.
- Expanded test coverage to previously unreachable environments by implementing a VirtualBox-based cross-platform solution.

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## **Lead QA Tester | Quality Assurance Tester**

DocbookMD | Austin, TX

July 2012 to April 2013

Founded the QA function for a HIPAA-compliant healthcare messaging app, establishing regulatory-grade quality processes and validation strategy from zero.

- Analyzed and documented HIPAA compliance requirements, ensuring the app met regulatory standards for secure transmission of patient health information.
- Built the initial test strategy and QA documentation from scratch, gating releases against both business and HIPAA compliance requirements.
- Ran functional, regression, and HIPAA compliance validation across all supported mobile devices, creatively simulating wifi outages to catch edge cases scripted testing misses.

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## **QA Test Lead | QA Tester**

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX  
August 2011 to April 2012

Contracted as QA Tester at Heatwave Interactive and promoted to Test Lead, authoring test documentation and leading a team across multiple game titles.

- Authored test plans and documentation for smoke and regression cycles, improving coverage and consistency.
- Led and mentored a team of testers, raising the bar on documentation quality and execution consistency.
- Ran daily validation of game builds for core functionality, gameplay mechanics, and UI integrity.

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## **Event Coordinator and Host**

Kick Butt Coffee | Austin, TX  
January 2011 to April 2012

Organized and ran weekly dance events, handling vendors, tech setup, and community promotion.

- Ran weekly events, coordinating DJs, venue logistics, and crowd engagement.
- Set up audio and event tech to integrate with the venue's house sound system.
- Ran event promotion and community outreach through social media.

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## **Game Master | Customer Experience & Trust Specialist**

Blizzard Entertainment | Austin, TX  
July 2010 to July 2011

Delivered high-touch customer support for World of Warcraft, analyzing complex cases and documenting findings for development teams while maintaining user trust in a high-volume environment.

- Analyzed and documented fraud and exploitation cases, delivering detailed root cause reports to development teams.
- De-escalated emotionally charged escalations through patient listening, restoring lost items and accounts and turning frustrated users into loyal ones.
- Delivered high-volume support via live chat and ticket systems, balancing efficiency with genuine care.
- Restored compromised accounts with precision, following strict security and data integrity protocols.

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## **QA Analyst | Support Tools Developer | Community Operations**

Linden Lab | San Francisco, CA (Remote)  
March 2007 to June 2010

Promoted three times from frontline support to QA Analyst, identifying operational gaps and building tools while establishing customer support processes.

- Built custom diagnostic tools to address operational gaps identified in support workflows.
- Established customer support processes and documentation using the Parature ticket system and live chat.
- As QA Analyst, tested daily builds and documented complex issues for engineering handoff.
- Served as frontline First Responder, handling in-world emergencies, enforcing Terms of Service, and resolving user conflicts.

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## **QA Tester**

Super Happy Fun Fun | Austin, TX  
November 2006 to February 2007

Cross-platform compatibility testing for mobile games across 100+ device models, documenting platform-specific issues and building strategies for fragmented environments.

- Ran functional and compatibility testing across 100+ unique device models, building strategies for efficient testing across fragmented hardware and software platforms.

- Tracked platform-specific bugs in Mantis with detailed analysis for developers.
  - Maintained quality oversight from initial builds through production patches.
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### **QA Test Lead, QA Game Tester**

Aspyr Media | Austin, TX

February 2006 to November 2006

Handled QA for high-profile Mac game ports, authoring test documentation and partnering with development to isolate platform-specific issues.

- Authored test protocols and documentation to guide the testing team and establish organized standards.
  - Validated major titles including Call of Duty 2 and Civilization IV through functional, compatibility, and regression testing, partnering with developers to isolate Mac-specific issues for stable launches.
  - Documented, tracked, and verified defects in JIRA and DevTrack with clear, actionable reports.
  - Caught localization and UI text errors through exhaustive proofreading, improving the polish of shipped titles.
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### **Executive Assistant**

LOC Consultants | Austin, TX

October 2005 to January 2006

Bilingual administrative support for an architectural firm, coordinating executive schedules and serving as primary communication point for a diverse client base.

- Delivered bilingual customer service in English and Spanish, handling high-volume communications and directing inquiries for a diverse client base.
  - Managed the executive calendar, prioritizing scheduling conflicts.
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### **Receptionist**

GoDance Studios | Austin, TX

April 2005 to September 2005

Front desk point of contact for a dance studio, handling customer interactions and administrative operations.

- Handled customer check-ins and new student reservations, keeping the front desk running smoothly.
  - Fielded inquiries from prospective students, explaining program details and booking reservations.
  - Processed cash and card payments accurately.
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### **Animator**

Diva Productions | Austin, TX

November 2004 to April 2005

Owned the full animation production pipeline for educational children's content, running projects from script through final delivery.

- Ran end-to-end animation projects: writing scripts, building storyboards and animatics, and delivering final animations.
  - Designed content to engage young audiences and reinforce learning objectives.
  - Coordinated audio editing, syncing dialogue and sound to animated sequences.
  - Maintained the studio's web presence and updates.
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### **Building Monitor**

UT Performing Arts Center | Austin, TX

October 2004 to November 2004

Provided security and access control for live performances at UT Performing Arts Center.

- Monitored venue access points, balancing performer access with security requirements.
  - Maintained audience safety during performances.
  - Ran building safety checks to identify and address issues before they escalated.
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## **Designer**

El Dia Daily Newspaper (Cuatro Communications) | Houston, TX

May 2004 to August 2004

Layout designer for a Spanish-language daily newspaper, working under daily deadline pressure to prepare content for publication.

- Designed and laid out newspaper pages in QuarkXPress and Adobe InDesign, supporting a platform migration between the two.
  - Edited headlines and adjusted layouts under daily deadline pressure.
  - Worked entirely in Spanish within a bilingual newsroom.
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## **Digital Artist / Webmaster**

Computer Discovery Center | Houston, TX

July 2002 to June 2004

Provided professional photo services and client consultation, turning customer requests into polished deliverables.

- Consulted with customers to understand requirements and turn requests into polished final products.
  - Performed detailed photo editing and restoration in Adobe Photoshop.
  - Supported artists with Giclée printing workflows, meeting print quality standards.
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## **Minister / Web Master**

Weddings Performed | Houston, TX

July 2002 to July 2003

Ordained wedding officiant performing bilingual ceremonies, gathering requirements from couples to craft personalized experiences.

- Consulted with couples to understand their vision and craft customized ceremonies.
  - Officiated ceremonies for diverse couples, delivering personalized services in English and Spanish.
  - Tutored the business owner on web design so they could maintain their own website.
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## **Temp Worker**

Adecco Temp Agency | Houston, TX

October 2002 to December 2003

Handled admin assignments across multiple client offices in document modernization and legal redlining.

- Assisted businesses with document modernization and updates.
  - Learned document redlining processes for legal review.
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## **Intern**

Wild Brain | San Francisco, CA

January 2002 to April 2002

Interned at a professional animation studio, gaining production exposure while supporting operations.

- Supported studio operations through office assistance and workspace organization.
- Got hands-on experience with digital coloring workflows for animated productions.
- Developed traditional animation skills on professional equipment.

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## Teaching Assistant

Vista College | Berkeley, CA  
October 2001 to May 2002

TA in a college design lab, tutoring students on Adobe applications and keeping workstations running for daily classes.

- Tutored students in Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, and other applications.
- Troubleshoot lab workstations to keep them functional for class.

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## Graphic Designer

Management Strategies International | Berkeley, CA  
November 2001 to February 2002

Created graphics and visual assets for client deliverables, collaborating with the team to meet content and client requirements.

- Designed graphics for client brochures and technical documentation.
- Produced print-ready assets meeting project specifications.
- Collaborated with the team to align designs with content and client requirements.

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## Temporary Administrative Assistant

Adecco Northwest Division | Emeryville, CA  
February 2001 to November 2001

Placed on multiple assignments across biotech (Chiron) and educational tech (Leap Frog).

- Assisted Chiron with decommissioning and archiving materials for a research project.
- Supported Leap Frog product development, working with prototypes and creating educational quiz content.

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## Contract Graphic Designer

DigitalThink.com | San Francisco  
July 2000 to October 2000

Created visual assets for an eLearning platform, collaborating with course developers to communicate technical concepts visually.

- Designed instructional graphics to support technical eLearning course content.
- Partnered with course developers to visually communicate complex concepts for online learners.
- Optimized images for web delivery.

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## Designer / Media Consultant

Mediaplex | San Francisco, CA  
September 1999 to June 2000

Rich Media specialist researching emerging technologies and translating technical specifications into useful direction for engineering and product teams.

- Researched emerging web technologies and translated complex specifications into direction engineering and product could act on.
- Partnered with engineering and product teams to expand platform capabilities based on research findings.
- Evaluated browser ecosystems and compatibility requirements to shape cross-platform strategies.

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## Contract Instructor

Media Alliance | San Francisco, CA  
March 2001 to February 2002



Ran adult-ed workshops on Office, Photoshop, and web fundamentals for beginners entering the workforce.

- Designed and taught structured workshops on Microsoft Office Suite, Adobe Photoshop, and web fundamentals.
- Provided one-on-one tutoring and technical assistance to keep students moving.
- Managed the computer lab, keeping equipment and software ready for daily classes.

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### **Instructor**

Tele Atlas (Formerly Etak) | Menlo Park, CA

November 2000 to January 2001

Developed and delivered training programs on data collection methodologies, evaluating trainee performance against quality standards.

- Developed and delivered training on data collection techniques, observational best practices, and proprietary software.
- Evaluated trainee performance through practical exercises and assessments to keep them aligned with quality guidelines.
- Provided constructive feedback and one-on-one coaching to improve trainee accuracy and efficiency.
- Served as go-to resource for protocol clarification, contributing to data quality improvement.

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### **Contract Instructor**

Bay Area Video Coalition | San Francisco, CA

October 1999 to May 2000

Taught advanced Adobe After Effects and Dreamweaver at a professional video coalition, mentoring students on portfolio-quality work.

- Developed and taught curricula for Adobe After Effects and Dreamweaver.
- Led multi-session workshops combining lecture, demonstration, and hands-on practice.
- Mentored students on digital media production best practices, strengthening portfolio quality.
- Provided constructive feedback on projects, fostering a collaborative learning environment.

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### **Instructor**

Houston Multimedia Center | Houston, TX

January 1997 to April 1998

Designed and taught web design and motion graphics courses, guiding adult learners from concept through execution on real projects.

- Developed curriculum and taught classes on Adobe PageMill, HTML, Photoshop, and After Effects.
- Broke down complex technical concepts into digestible lessons for varied learning styles.
- Guided students through hands-on projects from concept to execution, building practical skills.
- Provided individualized support and constructive feedback to help students master techniques.

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## **EDUCATION**

### **Austin Community College - Austin, TX**

American Sign Language

2015 – 2017

### **ASL School - Austin, TX**

American Sign Language

2008 – 2012

### **Vista College - Berkeley, CA**

Video Editing and Life Drawing

2001 – 2002

### **A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX**

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max  
1995 – 1996

**San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX**

Computer Science, Fine Art  
1993 – 1995

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Online version: <https://johnesco.github.io/resume>